

OFFICIAL PROGRAMME

Merge Film Festival 2026



1–4 October 2026

MASSAGNO

5 October · Bellinzona · Outside the festival

Thursday

1 OCTOBER 2026

One evening on the big screen.

20:30

20:30–23:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

Opening ceremony · Memory of Princess Mumbi

The festival opens and the film begins immediately afterwards in the same auditorium. One ticket for the whole evening.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Friday

2 OCTOBER 2026

Private school sessions in the morning, followed by the first two competition programmes, the discussion and the Swiss awards. Piazza Grande is open from 18:00 to 01:00, with food and drinks.

09:00	09:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Masterclass for arts high schools · Antonella Autuori (SUPSI) Schools only
10:00	10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Out of competition · WALL·E CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Andrew Stanton, Pixar, 2008 · 98 min.
13:30	13:30–15:30 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Masterclass for science high schools · Stefano Peduzzi (SUPSI) Schools only
14:00	14:00–15:30 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 1 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Seven short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.
17:00	17:00–18:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM FORMA APERTA · Where does the creative process live? Free admission Open talk and launch of FORMA APERTA, with Felix Bachmann, Kevin Merz, Manuela Bachmann and Simona Gamba.
18:30	18:30–20:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Discussion with Alessandro Bavari and Dario Cirrincione Free admission Screening works by Alessandro Bavari: Cronache di Mare (WORLD PREMIERE), Artefatti, Raw War, The Freakpoint Range, UNKNOWN QUANTUM OBJECTS.
20:45	20:45 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Swiss Innovator Award · Swiss Press Award Included with the Programme 2 ticket
21:00	21:00–22:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 2 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Six short films, ≈ 60 min., with a Q&A with the directors in person.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Saturday

3 OCTOBER 2026

The busiest day: three competition programmes, a roundtable, a panel on the environmental impact of AI, a talk and the Critics' Award. Piazza Grande is open from 10:00 to 01:00, with food and drinks.

10:00	10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Out of competition · Wider than the Sky CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Valerio Jalongo.
10:00	10:00–13:00 · MASSAGNO SCHOOLS, AULA MAGNA Roundtable · How is the image changing? Schools only With Alessandro Bavari and Marco Longo · CISA and USI.
13:30	13:30–15:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 3 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Eight short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.
14:00	14:00–15:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Roundtable · Work and the role of human beings in the age of artificial intelligence Free admission With Marco Zaffalon, Colin Porlezza (USI), Javisth Chabria and Pierre Alexandre Tremblay. Screening of The Interview by Mark Wachholz. Moderated by Felix Bachmann (Centro Generativo). In collaboration with USI.
15:30	15:30–17:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 4 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Eight short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.
16:00	16:00–17:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Panel: The environmental impact of AI Free admission With Prof. Silvia Santini (USI), Dr Marta Soprana (LSE IDEAS) and Elettra Fiumi. Moderated by Ilaria Espa.
17:30	17:30–19:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Talk · Javisth Chabria and Kevin B. Lee (USI) Free admission Moderated by Felix Bachmann (Centro Generativo). In collaboration with USI.
21:00	21:00–22:30 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Critics' Award and In competition · Programme 5 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– The Critics' Award, followed by seven short films, ≈ 60 min., with a Q&A with the directors in person.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.

Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.

Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Sunday

4 OCTOBER 2026

The final out-of-competition screening, followed by the awards ceremony and a screening of the winning films immediately afterwards.

10:00

10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

Out of competition · title to be announced

We'll announce it soon.

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

15:00

15:00–16:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

Awards ceremony and screening of the winning films

The awards are presented, immediately followed by a screening of the winning films.

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Monday

5 OCTOBER 2026

The day after the closing ceremony the festival travels to Bellinzona as a guest of the Swiss {ai} Weeks. This one is outside the festival programme: free, in another town, and with a sign-up of its own.

16:00

16:00 · PALAZZO CIVICO, BELLINZONA · COUNCIL CHAMBER

Swiss {ai} Weeks · Memoria Viva

Free · sign-up required

Stories, voices and archives in the age of artificial intelligence. Merge brings a best of the 2026 selection, and artistic directors Dario Cirrincione and Francesco Poloni are in the room.

PROGRAMME

- 16:00** Welcome and opening remarks · Gaetano Biondo
- 16:15** Biography Library · Claudio Brignole
- 16:45** From Giorgino to Memoria Viva · Roberto Mazzantini
- 17:15** Screening · Giorgino and the dragon known as Oblivion
- 17:30** Discussion

Registration required: luma.com/jhp0ct2s

Guest event, outside the festival · Free · sign-up required

Memoria Viva is organised by Mazzantini & Associati SA and Biography Library within the Swiss {ai} Weeks, under the patronage of the Città di Bellinzona. Sign-up is confirmed by the organisers.